OAT DIGESTIVE BISCUITS

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	TOTAL TIME	OVEN
24 cookies	**25 min**	**about 45 min**	**350F / 180C for 14 min**

INGREDIENTS

45 ml	Milk
1 tsp	Molasses
300 g	Rolled oats
80 g	Oat flour
70 g	Dark brown sugar
1 tsp	Salt
1/2 tsp	Baking soda
170 g	Unsalted butter, cold

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F. Line a baking sheet with parchment or a nonstick liner.
2. Stir the milk and molasses together in a small bowl.
3. Cut the butter into 6 mm cubes.
4. In a food processor, grind the rolled oats to a fine meal. Follow with the oat flour, then the brown sugar, the salt and the baking soda, and run it until the mix looks even. Drop in the butter and process to a sandy texture. Pour in the milk and molasses and process just until the dough starts pulling together.
5. By hand, grind the oats fine in a spice grinder or blender. Tip them into a large bowl, add the oat flour, then the brown sugar, the salt and the baking soda, and whisk it all even. Rub the butter in with your fingers until the mixture is sandy. Add the milk and molasses and bring it together with a spatula, stopping as soon as it starts to hold.
6. Turn the dough onto a work surface and knead it a few times into one cohesive mass.
7. Take a tablespoon of dough at a time, roll it into a ball between your palms, and press it flat on the lined sheet. Each disc should end up about 6 mm thick.
8. Bake 7 minutes, turn the sheet around, and bake 7 minutes more, until the bottoms and the edges are golden brown.
9. Let them sit on the sheet 5 minutes, then move them to a wire rack.
10. Keep them in an airtight container at room temperature, where they hold a week.

NOTES

Nothing in the dough is wheat. The structure comes from ground rolled oats plus oat flour, so these are gluten-free if the oats are certified.
A tablespoon of dough per biscuit is what lands the yield at 24. Bigger discs will not bake through in 14 minutes.
The butter goes in cold and is cut or rubbed only to a sandy stage, which is what keeps the texture flaky rather than solid.
300 g of rolled oats against 70 g of sugar puts these on the savory side of a sweet biscuit, and the teaspoon of salt is deliberate.
About 10 of them, 150 g, crumble into a 23 cm gluten-free pie shell or a 25 cm cheesecake base.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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